School Ratings and Enrollment Choices of Limited English Proficient Families

Evidence from Texas Elementary Schools

Job Market Paper

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Motivation

- School accountability reports provide detailed information on school performance, but accessing and interpreting this information can be costly.
- School ratings summarize this information into a simple and salient signal of school quality.
- Families of Limited English Proficient (LEP) students may face additional language barriers, alongside socioeconomic constraints that make school choice more costly.
- Simplified ratings could therefore be particularly valuable to these families.
- However, persistent information and school-choice frictions may limit their ability to respond to ratings.

The Research Questions

This paper answers the following questions:

1. Do school accountability ratings affect the enrollment choices of Hispanic LEP students?
2. Do their responses differ from those of non-LEP students?
3. Do Hispanic LEP responses vary with school availability and school-level LEP concentration?

Related Literature and Contribution

- **School accountability affects achievement and educator behavior**
  Neal and Schanzenbach (2010); Dee and Jacob (2011); Cullen et al. (2024)
  - **This paper:** studies family enrollment decisions as another margin through which accountability may matter
- **Families respond to school-quality information and school choice**
  Figlio and Lucas (2004); Hastings and Weinstein (2007); Andrabi et al. (2017); Corradini (2024); Cohodes et al. (2025)
  - **This paper:** studies a public rating released through an existing accountability system in a neighborhood-assignment setting, rather than information delivered directly to families
- **Most research on English Learners studies choices between bilingual education, ESL, and English immersion**
  Chin et al. (2013); Jepsen (2010)
  - **This paper:** shifts the focus from LEP-targeted programs to how LEP families use general information about school quality

Findings and Implications

- Little evidence of a Hispanic LEP enrollment response at any of the three rating thresholds.
- Demographically comparable non-LEP groups respond positively at the Acceptable threshold, but the estimates are sensitive to bandwidth.
- At the Exemplary threshold, all non-LEP enrollment rises by 1.9%; incoming transfers rise by 1.5 pp of baseline enrollment.
- Hispanic LEP vs. non-LEP differences are not statistically significant.
- In above-median-LEP-concentration schools, Hispanic LEP enrollment rises by 7.2% at the Acceptable threshold.
- **Implication:** Making school-quality information public does not necessarily produce uniform behavioral responses.

Context

- I study the effect of school accountability ratings in Texas elementary schools, 2001–2008
  - Excluding 2003, when no ratings were assigned
- Texas is an early adopter of school accountability
- Texas is large — enrolls 1 in 10 U.S. public school students
- In elementary schools, test performance alone determines ratings, so the information the rating conveys is easy to characterize

School ratings of elementary schools

- Schools are placed into four categories each year
  - Unacceptable, Acceptable, Recognized, and Exemplary
- Ratings based on students' overall and subgroup pass rates on standardized exams
- Ratings *and* the underlying pass rates are posted publicly online
- Schools must provide the report to parents, in English and Spanish
- Ratings are also covered extensively in local media

How ratings are determined

- Separate pass rates computed for each subject $\times$ demographic group
  - Groups: *All*, *Hispanic*, *White*, *Black*, and *Economically Disadvantaged*; only groups with ≥ 30 students count
  - Subjects: Math and Reading (grades 3–6), Writing (grade 4), Science (grade 5)
- Pass rates compared to statutory thresholds that vary by category and year
  - e.g. Exemplary typically requires $\geq 90\%$; Recognized 70–80%; Acceptable lower
- The subject-group with the lowest pass rate, i.e., the *marginal group*, determines the rating

Required improvement, exceptions, and fuzzy assignment

- **Required improvement:** schools below a threshold can still earn the higher rating if performance improved enough over the prior year
- **Exceptions:** a limited number of measures that narrowly miss the standard can be exempted
  - Restrictions apply, e.g. no exemption for the same group two years in a row
  - Neither provision can be used to obtain an Exemplary rating
- Crossing the statutory threshold sharply raises the probability of the higher rating but does not determine it in every case
  - $\Rightarrow$ fuzzy RD; I report intent-to-treat effects of crossing the cutoff

Timeline of ratings publication

- Student testing takes place in the spring of academic year t
- Ratings released to the public early in academic year $t+1$, just as schools start
- Too late to meaningfully affect enrollment decisions for that school year
- Use a two-year definition of outcomes
  - Relate enrollment changes between academic years t and $t+2$ to performance measured in spring of year t

Data sources

- Publicly available Texas Academic Excellence Indicator System (AEIS)
  - Accountability ratings and the pass rates used to calculate them
  - Used to reconstruct ratings and identify each school's marginal group, following Cullen et al. (2024)
- Restricted-use TEA administrative records from the Texas Education Research Center (ERC) at UT Dallas
  - Longitudinal student records permit following students across schools as long as they remain in the Texas public school system
  - Contains enrollment, performance, and demographics, including LEP classification, race/ethnicity, and free-lunch status
  - Used to construct student mobility outcomes

LEP classification and comparison groups

- LEP identified through state-approved oral language proficiency tests
  - A student is LEP if *ever* observed as LEP in the sample; never-LEP students are non-LEP
- Focus: **Hispanic LEP** students (91.5% of LEP students)
- Three non-LEP comparison groups:
  - **All non-LEP:** broad benchmark for the rest of the student population
  - **Hispanic non-LEP:** same ethnicity; potentially similar community and information networks
  - **Economically disadvantaged non-LEP:** socioeconomic benchmark

Outcomes of interest

- Enrollment change between t and $t+2$ (primary outcome)
- Student entry and exit between t and $t+2$, studied separately
  - Current students hold private information from experience in the school
  - Ratings should be more salient to families considering a move from another school or entry
- Express each outcome as a ratio of the group's year-t enrollment
- Restrict to schools offering the same grades from $t-2$ through $t+2$
  - Grade-configuration changes would mechanically shift enrollment

Identifying nonstructural moves

- Students change schools for structural reasons, e.g., the transition from elementary to middle school
- Structural moves difference out of enrollment *change* but inflate counts of entry and exit
- I isolate nonstructural moves in the channel measures:
  - **Incoming transfers:** students at another school in t who arrive by $t{+}2$, excluding flows where $> 35\%$ of the origin cohort moves to the same destination
  - **New entrants:** students at the school in $t{+}2$ not observed in Texas public schools in t
  - **Leavers:** students at the school in t but not in $t{+}2$, excluding the terminal grade and one grade below

Who are LEP students in Texas?

- LEP students account for 29.2% of total enrollment; 91.5% are Hispanic and 94.6% are ever FRL-eligible.

	Hispanic LEP	**All Non-LEP**	**Hispanic Non-LEP**	**Econ. Dis. Non-LEP**
Ever Economically Disadvantaged	0.974	0.636	0.848	1.000
Urban School	0.614	0.439	0.568	0.499
Suburban School	0.269	0.337	0.259	0.271
Town/Rural School	0.117	0.224	0.173	0.231
Mean Group Enrollment	154.69	400.15	128.04	254.32
School-Year Observations	15,553	15,793	15,759	15,793

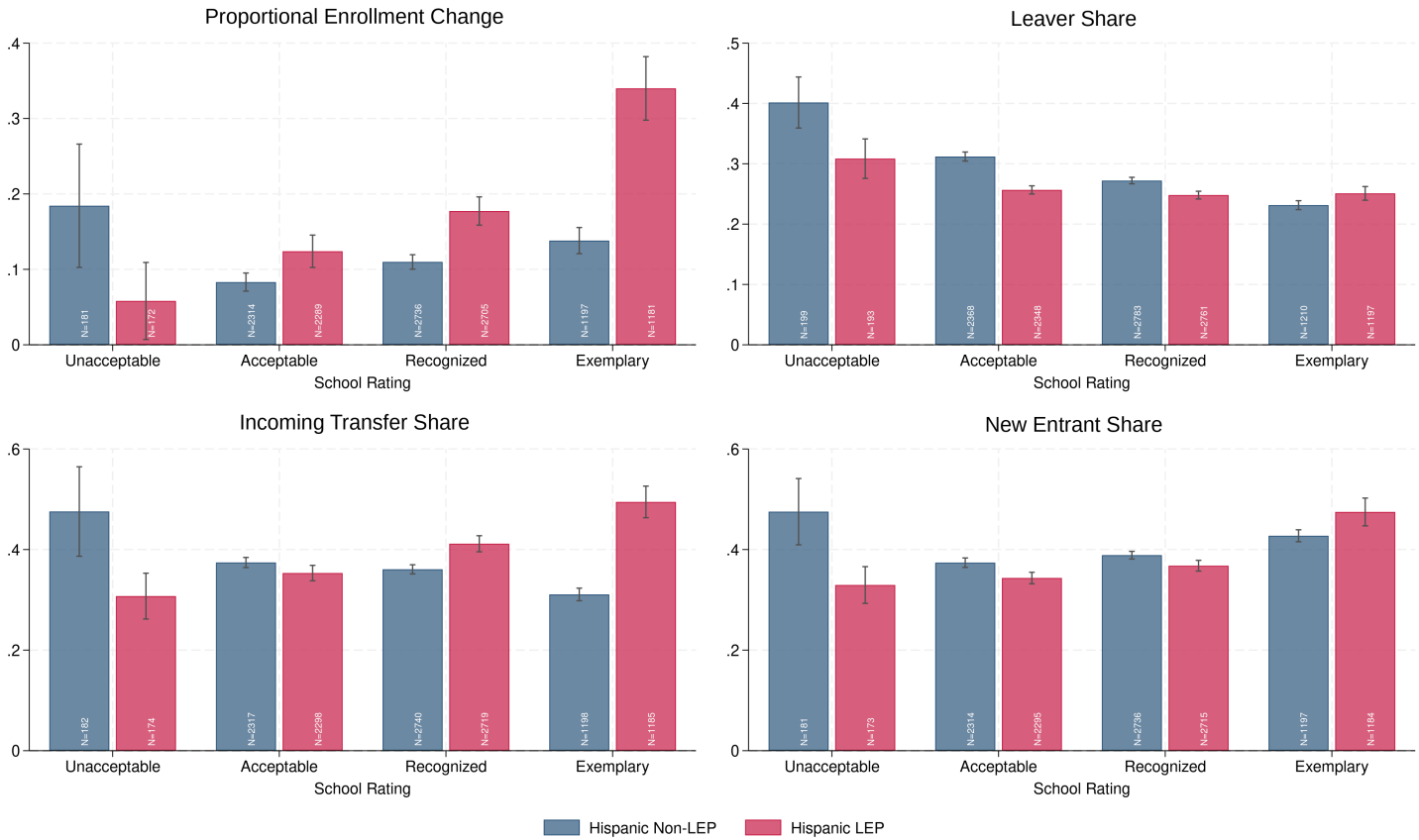
- Hispanic LEP students are overwhelmingly economically disadvantaged and more often in urban schools.
- **This motivates the focus on Hispanic LEP students** and the three non-LEP benchmarks.

Distribution of Students by Group & Rating Category (%)

	School Rating			
	Unacceptable	**Acceptable**	**Recognized**	**Exemplary**
Hispanic LEP	2.0	52.1	38.6	7.3
All Non-LEP	1.0	34.3	45.4	19.3
Hispanic Non-LEP	0.9	41.3	46.2	11.6
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP	1.4	42.3	45.2	11.1

- Over half of Hispanic LEP students attend Acceptable schools; only 7.3% attend Exemplary schools.
- Economically disadvantaged non-LEP students have the closest distribution to Hispanic LEP students.

Hispanic Student Mobility, by Rating and LEP Status



- Raw Hispanic LEP enrollment growth rises with ratings; Hispanic non-LEP is flatter.
- Descriptive only: differently rated schools differ in many ways — not causal.

Empirical strategy

- School ratings are correlated with student composition and school characteristics
- I identify the effect of crossing a rating threshold using a RD design
- Schools just above and just below a statutory cutoff have similar underlying performance but face a discrete change in the probability of a higher rating
- Identification requires that schools cannot precisely manipulate the running variable and that other determinants of outcomes vary smoothly through the threshold
- The design tests whether the *label* changes behavior among similarly performing schools — not responses to larger quality differences

Constructing the running variable

- Running variable: marginal-group pass rate relative to the statutory threshold

$$R_{st}^{k} = p_{st} - c_{st}^{k}, \qquad k \in \{\text{Acceptable, Recognized, Exemplary}\}$$

- Separate running variables for the Acceptable, Recognized, and Exemplary thresholds
- Reconstruct each school's rating and marginal group using the full assignment rules (thresholds, required improvement, exceptions) from Cullen et al. (2024)
- Correctly predict approximately 98% of observed ratings

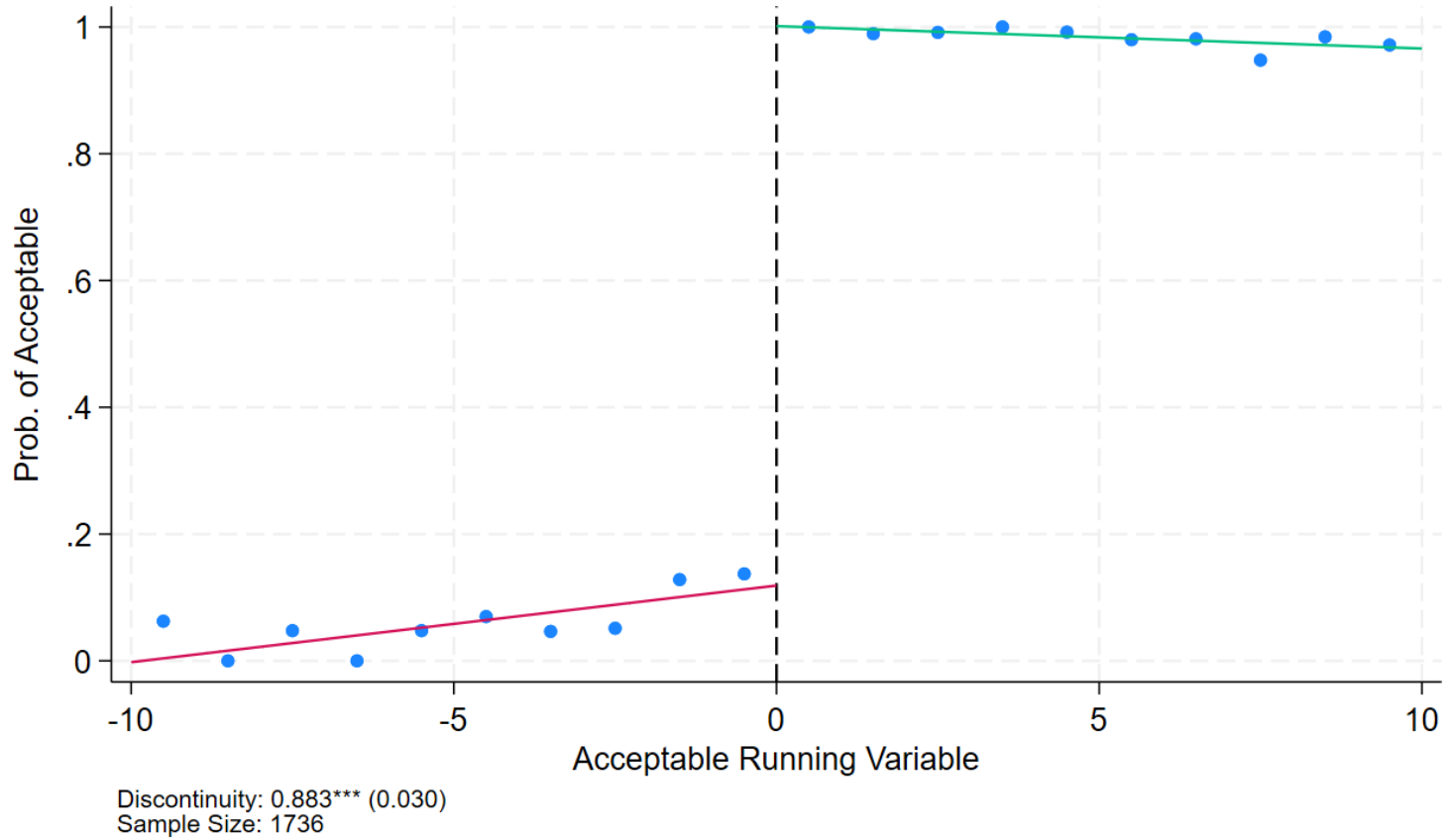
Regression Discontinuity Design

$$Y_{gst} = \alpha + \beta \mathbf{1}(R^k_{st} \geq 0) + \gamma_1 R^k_{st} + \gamma_2 \mathbf{1}(R^k_{st} \geq 0) \times R^k_{st} + \varepsilon_{gst} \quad \text{(Reduced Form)}$$

$$D^k_{st} = \pi_0 + \pi_1 \mathbf{1}(R^k_{st} \geq 0) + \pi_2 R^k_{st} + \pi_3 \mathbf{1}(R^k_{st} \geq 0) \times R^k_{st} + u_{st} \quad \text{(First Stage)}$$

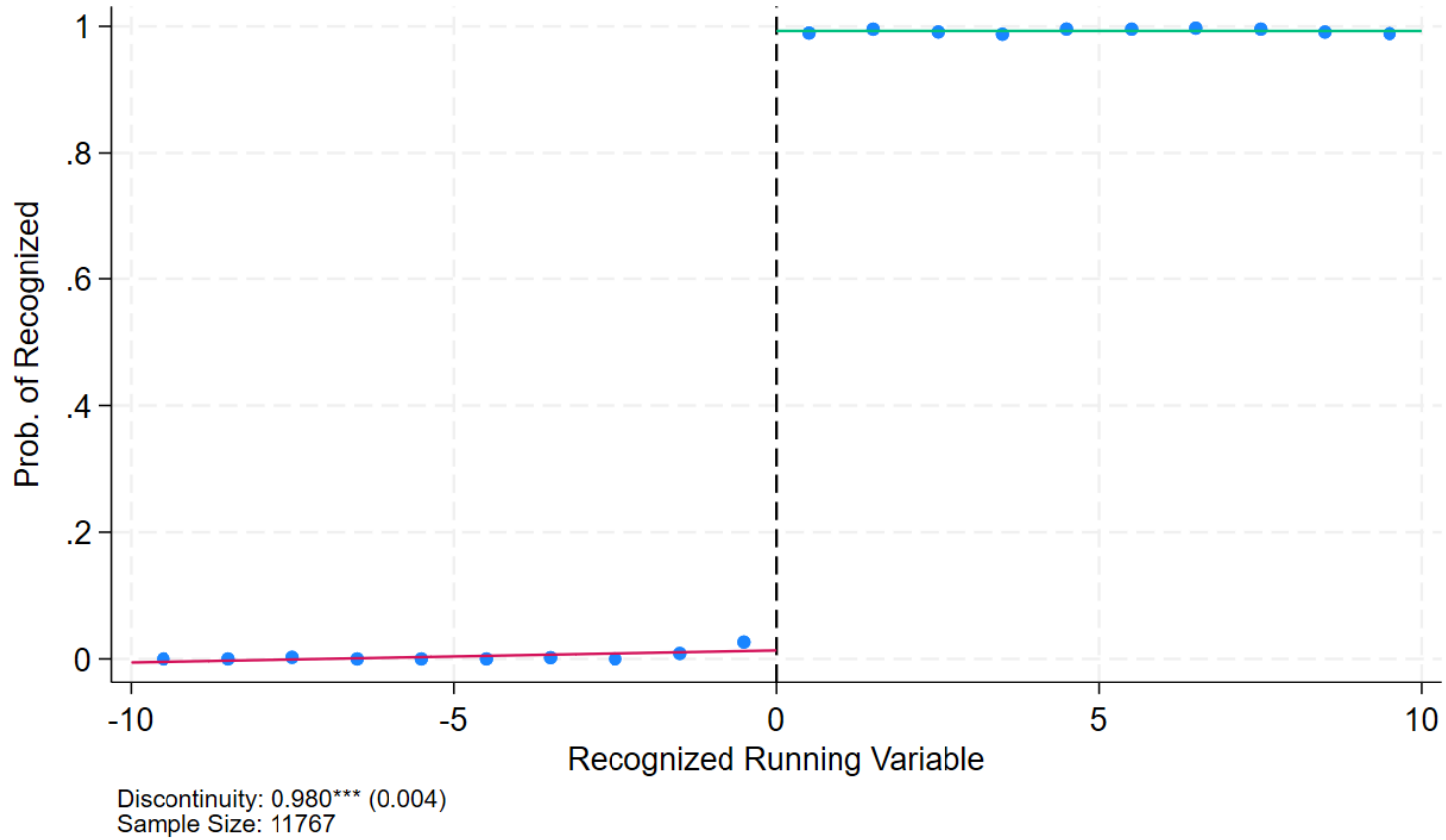
- R^k_{st} is the centered running variable for rating margin k
- D^k_{st} indicates whether the school receives a rating at or above the relevant category
- Y_{gst} is an enrollment or mobility outcome for student group g, normalized by year-t group enrollment
- β is the reduced-form effect of crossing the statutory cutoff; π_1 is the first stage

First stage: Acceptable threshold



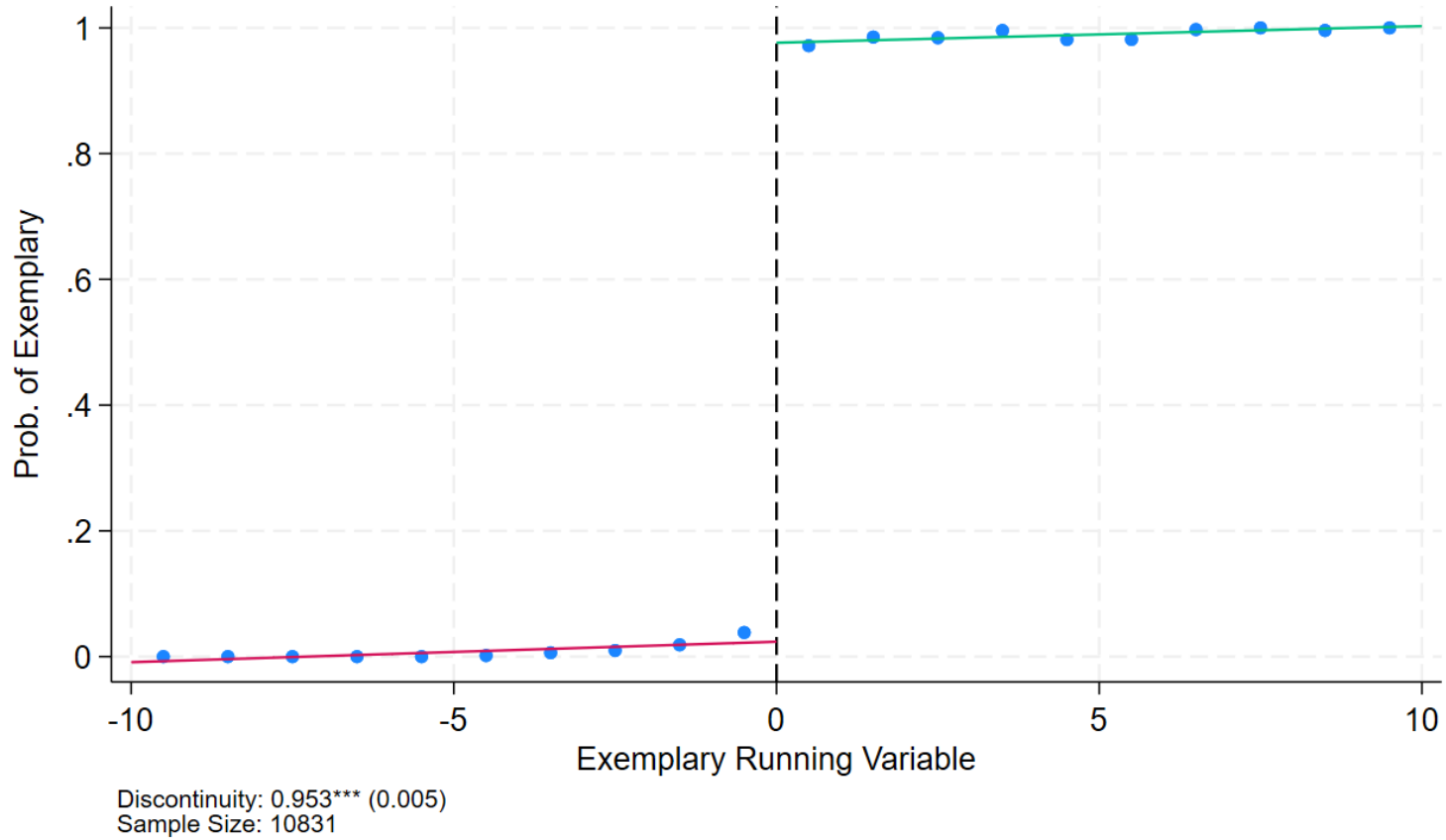
Crossing the cutoff raises the probability of an Acceptable rating by 88.3 pp.

First stage: Recognized threshold



Crossing the cutoff raises the probability of a Recognized rating by 98.0 pp.

First stage: Exemplary threshold



Crossing the cutoff raises the probability of an Exemplary rating by 95.3 pp.

Balance - School Characteristics

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Urban School	0.04	-0.02	0.01
	(0.091)	(0.029)	(0.030)
Mean	0.60	0.46	0.38
Suburban School	0.05	0.03	0.03
	(0.060)	(0.026)	(0.029)
Mean	0.15	0.27	0.34
Hispanic Share	-0.00	0.00	0.02
	(0.060)	(0.019)	(0.019)
Mean	0.58	0.51	0.36
LEP Share	0.02	-0.00	0.02
	(0.047)	(0.014)	(0.012)
Mean	0.38	0.28	0.19
Economically Disadvantaged Share	-0.02	-0.00	-0.00
	(0.047)	(0.015)	(0.016)
Mean	0.69	0.55	0.41

Density Bandwidth 4

Balance - Hispanic LEP & All Non-LEP

	Acceptable	**Recognized**	**Exemplary**
Hisp. LEP Enrollment (t)	5.01	-2.98	13.35
	(39.356)	(11.201)	(8.406)
Mean	231.63	167.40	98.01
Hisp. LEP Enroll. Change Ratio $(t-2$ to $t)$	-0.05	-0.02	-0.16
	(0.084)	(0.059)	(0.171)
Mean	0.25	0.24	0.38
All Non-LEP Enrollment (t)	-23.50	17.81*	-12.03
	(27.619)	(10.821)	(12.265)
Mean	296.68	389.38	446.85
All Non-LEP Enroll. Change Ratio $(t-2$ to $t)$	0.02	0.02**	-0.01
	(0.038)	(0.009)	(0.010)
Mean	-0.03	-0.01	0.00

Bandwidth 4

Balance - Other Non-LEP Groups

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Hisp. Non-LEP Enrollment (t)	-9.13	6.20	1.69
	(16.277)	(7.351)	(6.887)
Mean	102.66	140.92	114.08
Hisp. Non-LEP Enroll. Change Ratio ($t-2$ to t)	-0.01	0.03	0.01
	(0.066)	(0.022)	(0.025)
Mean	0.08	0.10	0.13
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP Enrollment (t)	-10.56	10.76	-1.14
	(23.827)	(7.596)	(7.373)
Mean	257.48	275.28	223.45
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP Enroll. Change Ratio ($t-2$ to t)	0.02	0.02**	-0.02
	(0.038)	(0.010)	(0.016)
Mean	-0.01	0.02	0.04

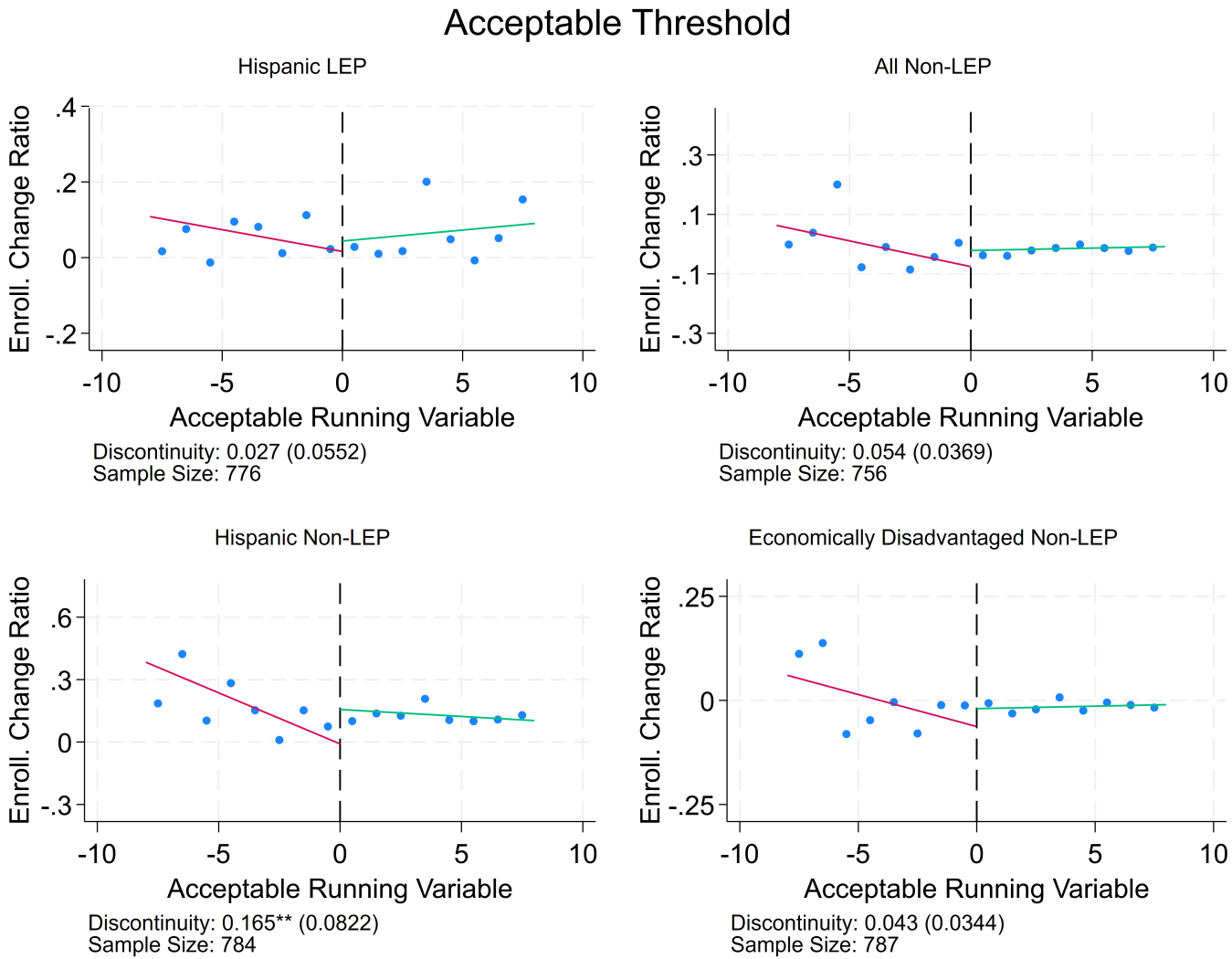
Bandwidth 4

Effect of Crossing a Rating on Enrollment Change

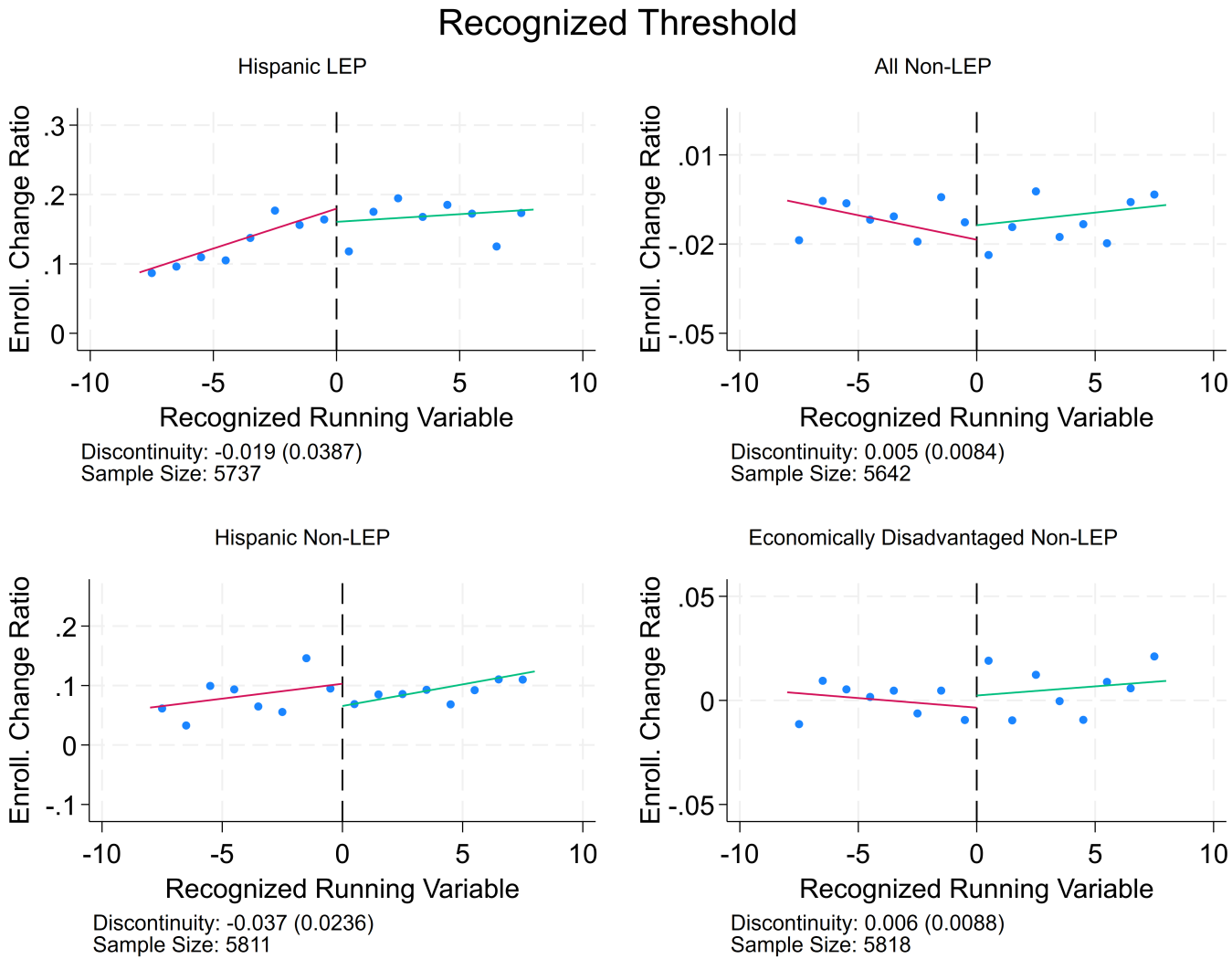
	Hispanic LEP	All Non-LEP	Hispanic Non-LEP	Econ. Dis. Non-LEP
Acceptable	0.027	0.054	0.165**	0.043
	(0.055)	(0.037)	(0.082)	(0.034)
Outcome Mean	0.06	-0.02	0.16	-0.01
Recognized	-0.019	0.005	-0.037	0.006
	(0.039)	(0.008)	(0.024)	(0.009)
Outcome Mean	0.14	-0.01	0.08	-0.00
Exemplary	-0.031	0.019**	0.023	0.007
	(0.046)	(0.007)	(0.023)	(0.012)
Outcome Mean	0.22	-0.01	0.10	0.00

Bandwidths

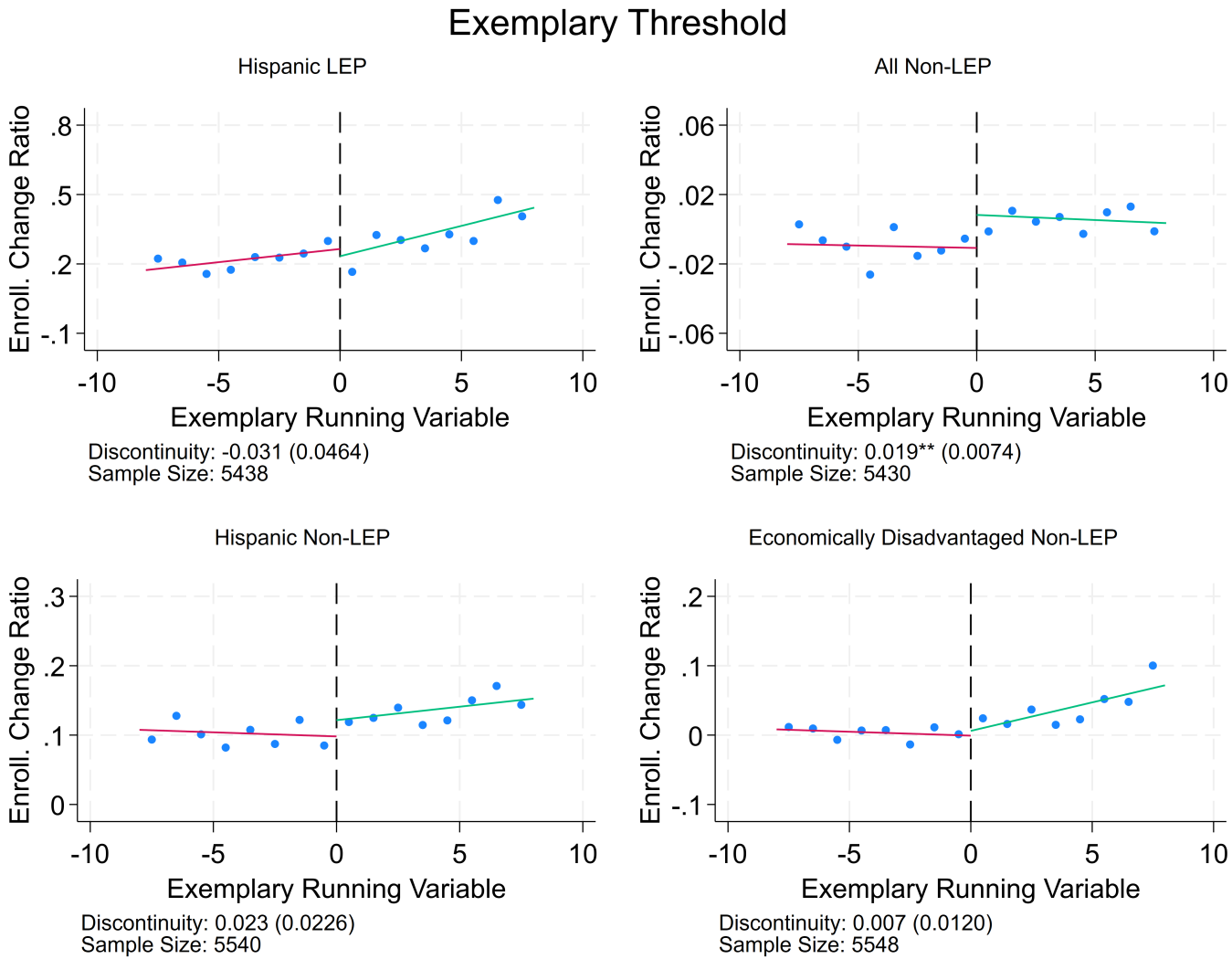
Enrollment Change by Student Group: Acceptable Margin



Enrollment Change by Student Group: Recognized Margin



Enrollment Change by Student Group: Exemplary Margin



Hispanic LEP vs. Non-LEP: Differences

	All Non-LEP	Hispanic Non-LEP	Econ. Dis. Non-LEP
Acceptable			
Comparison Group	0.054	0.165**	0.043
	(0.037)	(0.082)	(0.034)
Hispanic LEP	0.027	0.027	0.027
	(0.055)	(0.055)	(0.055)
Difference	-0.027	-0.138	-0.016
	(0.065)	(0.089)	(0.063)
Recognized			
Comparison Group	0.005	-0.037	0.006
	(0.008)	(0.024)	(0.009)
Hispanic LEP	-0.019	-0.019	-0.019
	(0.039)	(0.039)	(0.039)
Difference	-0.024	0.018	-0.025
	(0.040)	(0.045)	(0.039)
Exemplary			
Comparison Group	0.019**	0.023	0.007
	(0.007)	(0.023)	(0.012)
Hispanic LEP	-0.031	-0.031	-0.031
	(0.046)	(0.046)	(0.046)
Difference	-0.050	-0.055	-0.038
	(0.047)	(0.050)	(0.047)

- Most gaps are negative, but none is statistically significant

Effect of Crossing a Rating on Incoming Transfers

	Hispanic LEP	All Non-LEP	Hispanic Non-LEP	Econ. Dis. Non-LEP
Acceptable	0.033	0.095***	0.177*	0.103***
	(0.050)	(0.029)	(0.107)	(0.031)
Recognized	-0.023	0.003	-0.019	0.002
	(0.026)	(0.008)	(0.019)	(0.009)
Exemplary	-0.034	0.015**	0.006	-0.003
	(0.036)	(0.007)	(0.015)	(0.011)

- **Acceptable:** Hispanic LEP estimate small and insignificant; incoming transfers rise for all three non-LEP groups
- **Exemplary:** all non-LEP $+1.5$ pp of baseline enrollment ($p < 0.05$)

New Entrants & Leavers | RD Plots | Bandwidths

What the Main Results Show

- **Little evidence of a discontinuous Hispanic LEP enrollment response.** Estimates are imprecise at all three thresholds
- **Comparable non-LEP groups: positive at the Acceptable threshold.** Significant only for Hispanic non-LEP, and sensitive to bandwidth choice
- **All non-LEP students respond at the Exemplary threshold.** Enrollment $+1.9\%$, incoming transfers $+1.5$ pp; stable across fixed bandwidths
- **Formal tests do not establish significant Hispanic LEP vs. non-LEP differences.** Gaps are smaller relative to economically disadvantaged non-LEP students

Does the response vary with the school environment in which families encounter the rating?

Why Might the Average Hispanic LEP Response Be Weak?

- Possible explanations:
  - **Reach:** the rating does not reach or is not salient to these families
  - **Constraints:** families observe it but cannot act on it (finances, few nearby schools)
  - **Preferences:** families weigh school attributes not captured by test-based ratings, e.g. peers
- Families could also rely on public pass rates rather than the label
  - But this would weaken responses for all families, and some non-LEP groups do respond
- The data cannot separate these channels directly
  - I ask whether responses vary across school environments in informative ways

Heterogeneity by School Environment

- **Within-district school availability**
  - Above- vs. at/below-median number of elementary schools in the district
  - Proxy for nearby schooling options; families still generally must move to switch schools
  - If limited options mute the response, it should be stronger where options are greater
- **School LEP concentration**
  - Above- vs. at/below-median school LEP enrollment share
  - Larger co-linguistic community, parental networks, language-related resources
  - Could affect how the rating is transmitted or willingness to move
- Estimates show whether the effect of the rating *varies* across environments, not the causal effect of the environment itself

School Characteristics by School Availability

	Below Median	Above Median	Difference
Total School Enrollment	342.339	611.636	269.296
LEP Share	0.106	0.288	0.182
Economically Disadvantaged Share	0.547	0.509	-0.038
Hispanic LEP Share	0.102	0.264	0.162
Urban School	0.042	0.525	0.483
Suburban School	0.086	0.318	0.231
Town/Rural School	0.871	0.157	-0.714
Number of Elementary Schools in District	1.000	42.622	41.622

- Above-median districts: $\sim$43 elementary schools vs. 1; larger, far more urban, higher LEP share.
- The split also captures large urban vs. small rural districts.

School Characteristics by LEP Concentration

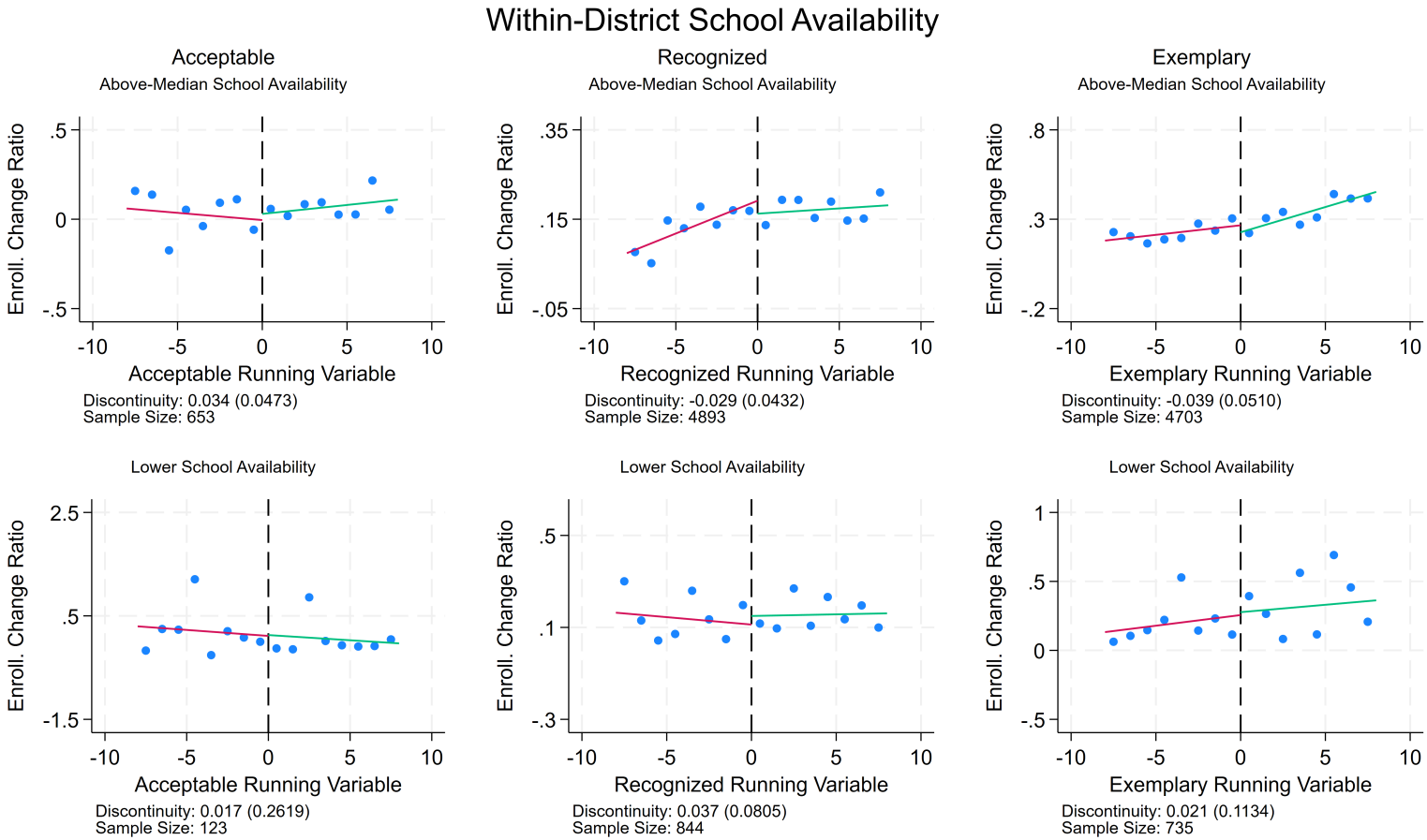
	Below Median	Above Median	Difference
Total School Enrollment	516.234	634.440	118.206
LEP Share	0.072	0.453	0.381
Economically Disadvantaged Share	0.441	0.589	0.148
Hispanic LEP Share	0.057	0.426	0.370
Urban School	0.332	0.579	0.247
Suburban School	0.292	0.277	-0.015
Town/Rural School	0.375	0.143	-0.232
Number of Elementary Schools in District	23.295	50.274	26.979

- High-LEP schools: 45.3% vs. 7.2% LEP; larger, more urban, more disadvantaged, in districts with more schools.
- LEP concentration is correlated with several features of the school environment.

Enrollment Change by School Availability

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Above-Median Number of Elementary Schools			
Hispanic LEP	0.034	-0.029	-0.039
	(0.047)	(0.043)	(0.051)
All Non-LEP	0.037	0.006	0.026***
	(0.039)	(0.010)	(0.008)
Hispanic Non-LEP	0.115	-0.030	0.034
	(0.077)	(0.026)	(0.024)
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP	0.032	0.006	0.009
	(0.038)	(0.010)	(0.014)
At/Below-Median Number of Elementary Schools			
Hispanic LEP	0.017	0.037	0.021
	(0.262)	(0.080)	(0.113)
All Non-LEP	0.106	-0.004	-0.018
	(0.100)	(0.013)	(0.014)
Hispanic Non-LEP	0.325	-0.078	-0.027
	(0.241)	(0.057)	(0.069)
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP	0.076	0.007	-0.001
	(0.078)	(0.015)	(0.018)

Hispanic LEP Enrollment Change by School Availability

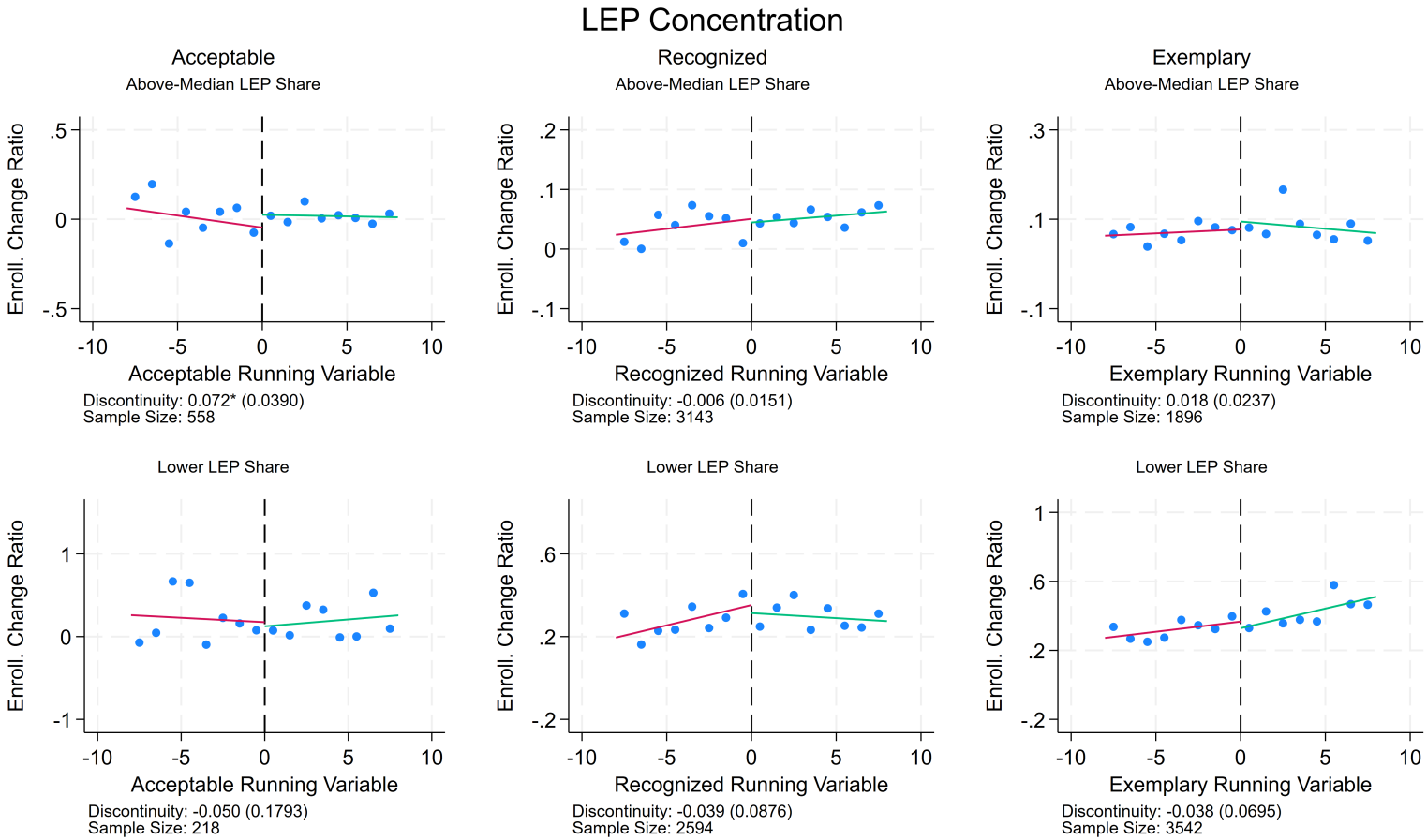


- No systematic pattern of stronger Hispanic LEP responses where more schools are available
- All non-LEP: $+2.6\%$ at Exemplary in above-median districts ($p < 0.01$)

Enrollment Change by LEP Concentration

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Above-Median LEP Share			
Hispanic LEP	0.072*	-0.006	0.018
	(0.039)	(0.015)	(0.024)
All Non-LEP	0.046	0.001	0.037**
	(0.044)	(0.013)	(0.015)
Hispanic Non-LEP	0.095	0.006	0.077
	(0.079)	(0.017)	(0.050)
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP	0.036	0.002	0.042***
	(0.043)	(0.013)	(0.016)
At/Below-Median LEP Share			
Hispanic LEP	-0.050	-0.039	-0.038
	(0.179)	(0.088)	(0.069)
All Non-LEP	-0.018	0.013	0.006
	(0.046)	(0.009)	(0.008)
Hispanic Non-LEP	0.097	-0.076	0.014
	(0.146)	(0.050)	(0.022)
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP	-0.011	0.012	-0.007
	(0.046)	(0.011)	(0.015)

Hispanic LEP Enrollment Change by LEP Concentration



- High-LEP schools: Hispanic LEP enrollment $+7.2\%$ at Acceptable ($p < 0.10$)
- Non-LEP groups also respond at Exemplary in high-LEP schools

Do Hispanic LEP Responses Differ Across Environments?

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Within-District School Availability			
Above-Median No. of Schools	0.034	-0.029	-0.039
	(0.047)	(0.043)	(0.051)
At/Below-Median No. of Schools	0.017	0.037	0.021
	(0.262)	(0.080)	(0.113)
Difference (Above − At/Below)	0.018	-0.066	-0.060
	(0.263)	(0.091)	(0.124)
LEP Concentration			
Above-Median LEP Share	0.072*	-0.006	0.018
	(0.039)	(0.015)	(0.024)
At/Below-Median LEP Share	-0.050	-0.039	-0.038
	(0.179)	(0.088)	(0.069)
Difference (Above − At/Below)	0.122	0.033	0.056
	(0.182)	(0.089)	(0.073)

- No differences are statistically significant
- LEP concentration: positive at all thresholds (12.2 pp at Acceptable), but imprecise

Spanish TV Analysis

Conclusion

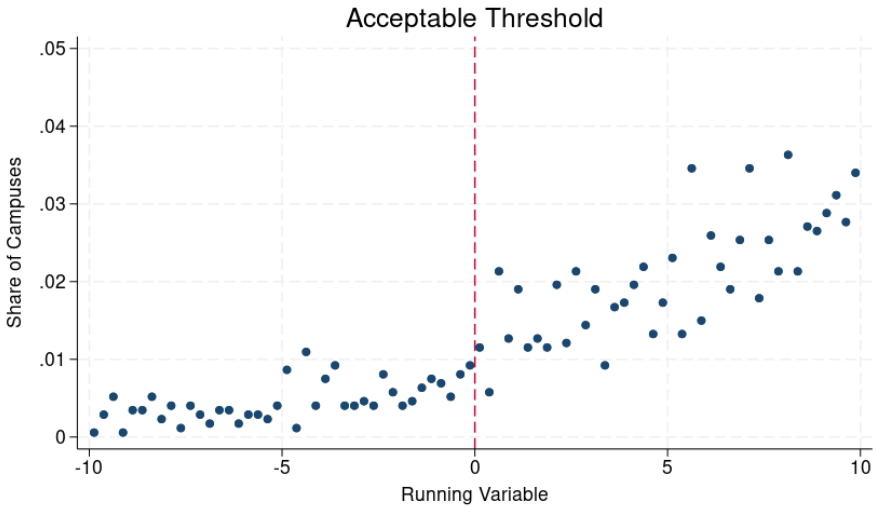
- **Little evidence of an average Hispanic LEP response** to crossing any of the three rating thresholds
- **Some non-LEP families respond to the rating signal:** Enrollment increases at the Exemplary threshold for all non-LEP students
- The differences relative to Hispanic LEP students are suggestive, but not statistically precise
- **The average Hispanic LEP null may mask heterogeneity across school environments:** At the Acceptable threshold, Hispanic LEP enrollment rises by 7.2% in high-LEP schools

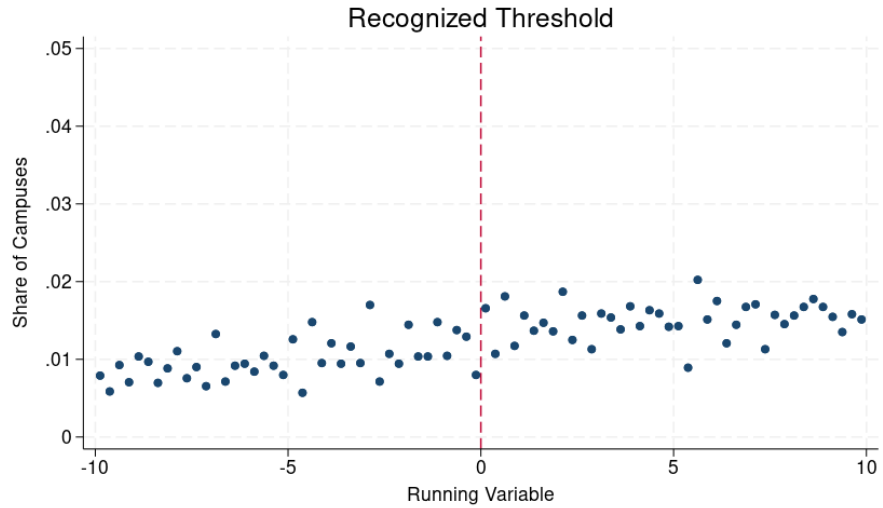
Takeaway

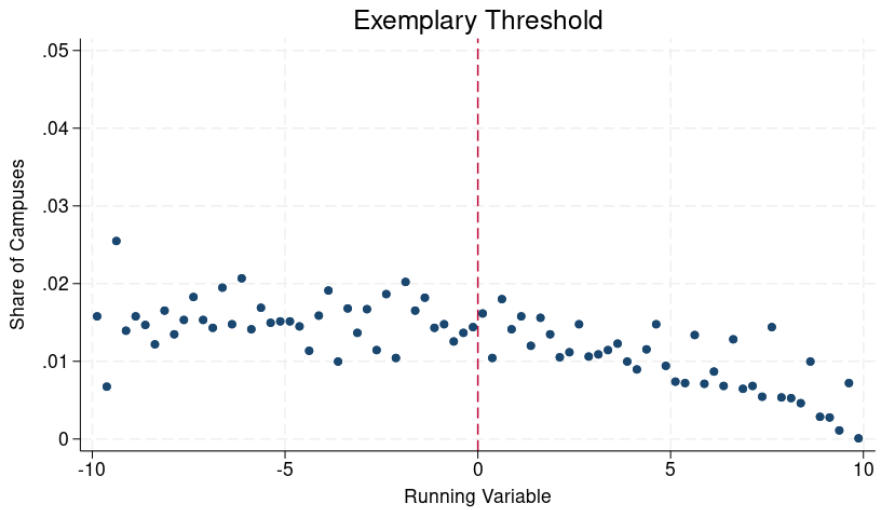
A simple public rating appears to influence some families, but its effect is more muted on average for Hispanic LEP families. The heterogeneity results suggest that this muted average response need not reflect uniform unresponsiveness: the environment in which families encounter and act on the rating may matter

Appendix

Density of the Running Variable







Share of campus-years in 0.25-pp bins of the running variable; dashed line at the threshold.

Back

Balance (BW 4) - School Characteristics

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Urban School	0.07	-0.04	-0.04
	(0.125)	(0.039)	(0.040)
Mean	0.58	0.47	0.39
Suburban School	0.08	0.04	0.07**
	(0.082)	(0.035)	(0.038)
Mean	0.18	0.27	0.33
Hispanic Share	0.10	-0.02	0.01
	(0.082)	(0.025)	(0.024)
Mean	0.57	0.52	0.37
LEP Share	0.11*	-0.02	0.01
	(0.065)	(0.019)	(0.016)
Mean	0.39	0.29	0.18
Economically Disadvantaged Share	-0.02	-0.01	0.00
	(0.066)	(0.020)	(0.022)
Mean	0.70	0.56	0.41

Back

Balance (BW 4) - Hispanic LEP & All Non-LEP

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Hisp. LEP Enrollment (t)	88.69	-16.52	6.02
	(53.931)	(15.512)	(11.461)
Mean	227.84	173.12	95.37
Hisp. LEP Enroll. Change Ratio $(t-2$ to $t)$	-0.05	-0.06	-0.30
	(0.097)	(0.085)	(0.245)
Mean	0.15	0.25	0.41
All Non-LEP Enrollment (t)	-38.50	27.70*	-16.97
	(38.007)	(14.392)	(15.953)
Mean	293.12	387.60	442.19
All Non-LEP Enroll. Change Ratio $(t-2$ to $t)$	-0.03	0.02*	-0.02
	(0.053)	(0.013)	(0.014)
Mean	-0.03	-0.01	-0.00

Back

Balance (BW 4) - Other Non-LEP Groups

	Acceptable	Recognized	Exemplary
Hisp. Non-LEP Enrollment (t)	4.13	0.08	-1.77
	(22.065)	(9.806)	(8.641)
Mean	100.17	141.09	116.86
Hisp. Non-LEP Enroll. Change Ratio $(t-2$ to $t)$	-0.10	0.04	0.00
	(0.091)	(0.028)	(0.032)
Mean	0.06	0.09	0.13
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP Enrollment (t)	-16.24	12.65	-5.37
	(33.493)	(10.288)	(9.549)
Mean	255.27	277.13	227.81
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP Enroll. Change Ratio $(t-2$ to $t)$	-0.05	0.03**	-0.04
	(0.052)	(0.014)	(0.025)
Mean	-0.01	0.02	0.03

Back

Enrollment Change: Alternative Bandwidths (1/2)

	Fixed Bandwidth				Optimal Bandwidth
	4	**6**	**8** *Baseline*	**10**	**Optimal**
Hispanic LEP					
Acceptable	-0.015	0.069	0.027	0.015	-0.010
	(0.056)	(0.065)	(0.055)	(0.053)	(0.060) [3.50]
Recognized	-0.006	-0.006	-0.019	-0.029	-0.002
	(0.053)	(0.045)	(0.039)	(0.036)	(0.043) [6.10]
Exemplary	-0.019	-0.053	-0.031	-0.027	-0.039
	(0.063)	(0.056)	(0.046)	(0.045)	(0.074) [2.23]
All Non-LEP					
Acceptable	0.009	0.008	0.054	0.013	0.031
	(0.045)	(0.037)	(0.037)	(0.030)	(0.040) [6.91]
Recognized	0.016	0.012	0.005	0.002	0.010
	(0.012)	(0.010)	(0.008)	(0.008)	(0.010) [5.57]
Exemplary	0.019*	0.015*	0.019**	0.020***	0.020
	(0.010)	(0.008)	(0.007)	(0.007)	(0.013) [2.40]

Other Groups Back

Enrollment Change: Alternative Bandwidths (2/2)

	Fixed Bandwidth				Optimal Bandwidth
	4	6	8 *Baseline*	10	Optimal
Hispanic Non-LEP					
Acceptable	0.069	0.106	0.165**	0.102	0.069
	(0.098)	(0.091)	(0.082)	(0.070)	(0.098) [4.05]
Recognized	-0.023	-0.021	-0.037	-0.034	-0.037
	(0.033)	(0.028)	(0.024)	(0.022)	(0.024) [8.02]
Exemplary	0.040	0.015	0.023	0.019	0.037
	(0.028)	(0.025)	(0.023)	(0.021)	(0.029) [2.91]
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP					
Acceptable	-0.005	-0.003	0.043	0.006	0.021
	(0.043)	(0.035)	(0.034)	(0.028)	(0.038) [6.77]
Recognized	0.021	0.016	0.006	0.003	0.020
	(0.013)	(0.010)	(0.009)	(0.008)	(0.012) [4.15]
Exemplary	0.021	0.012	0.007	0.016	0.018
	(0.013)	(0.011)	(0.012)	(0.010)	(0.018) [2.20]

Back

Incoming Transfers: Alternative Bandwidths (1/2)

	Fixed Bandwidth				Optimal Bandwidth
	4	**6**	**8** *Baseline*	**10**	**Optimal**
Hispanic LEP					
Acceptable	0.027	0.089	0.033	0.051	0.048
	(0.058)	(0.057)	(0.050)	(0.047)	(0.059) [3.47]
Recognized	-0.021	-0.020	-0.023	-0.030	-0.022
	(0.034)	(0.029)	(0.026)	(0.024)	(0.026) [7.05]
Exemplary	-0.018	-0.045	-0.034	-0.016	-0.012
	(0.049)	(0.044)	(0.036)	(0.034)	(0.056) [2.37]
All Non-LEP					
Acceptable	0.056	0.078***	0.095***	0.073***	0.043
	(0.036)	(0.029)	(0.029)	(0.025)	(0.038) [3.66]
Recognized	0.011	0.008	0.003	0.002	0.007
	(0.011)	(0.009)	(0.008)	(0.008)	(0.009) [6.03]
Exemplary	0.012	0.014*	0.015**	0.022***	0.006
	(0.010)	(0.008)	(0.007)	(0.007)	(0.013) [2.35]

Other Groups Back

Incoming Transfers: Alternative Bandwidths (2/2)

	Fixed Bandwidth				Optimal Bandwidth
	4	**6**	**8** *Baseline*	**10**	**Optimal**
Hispanic Non-LEP					
Acceptable	0.080	0.128	0.177*	0.131*	0.073
	(0.098)	(0.082)	(0.107)	(0.068)	(0.100) [3.86]
Recognized	-0.020	-0.017	-0.019	-0.016	-0.017
	(0.026)	(0.022)	(0.019)	(0.017)	(0.019) [8.16]
Exemplary	0.022	0.016	0.006	0.013	0.006
	(0.019)	(0.017)	(0.015)	(0.014)	(0.024) [1.84]
Econ. Dis. Non-LEP					
Acceptable	0.058	0.088***	0.103***	0.073***	0.083**
	(0.041)	(0.032)	(0.031)	(0.026)	(0.034) [5.73]
Recognized	0.016	0.009	0.002	0.003	0.010
	(0.012)	(0.010)	(0.009)	(0.008)	(0.010) [5.86]
Exemplary	0.009	0.003	-0.003	0.007	-0.001
	(0.013)	(0.011)	(0.011)	(0.010)	(0.019) [1.79]

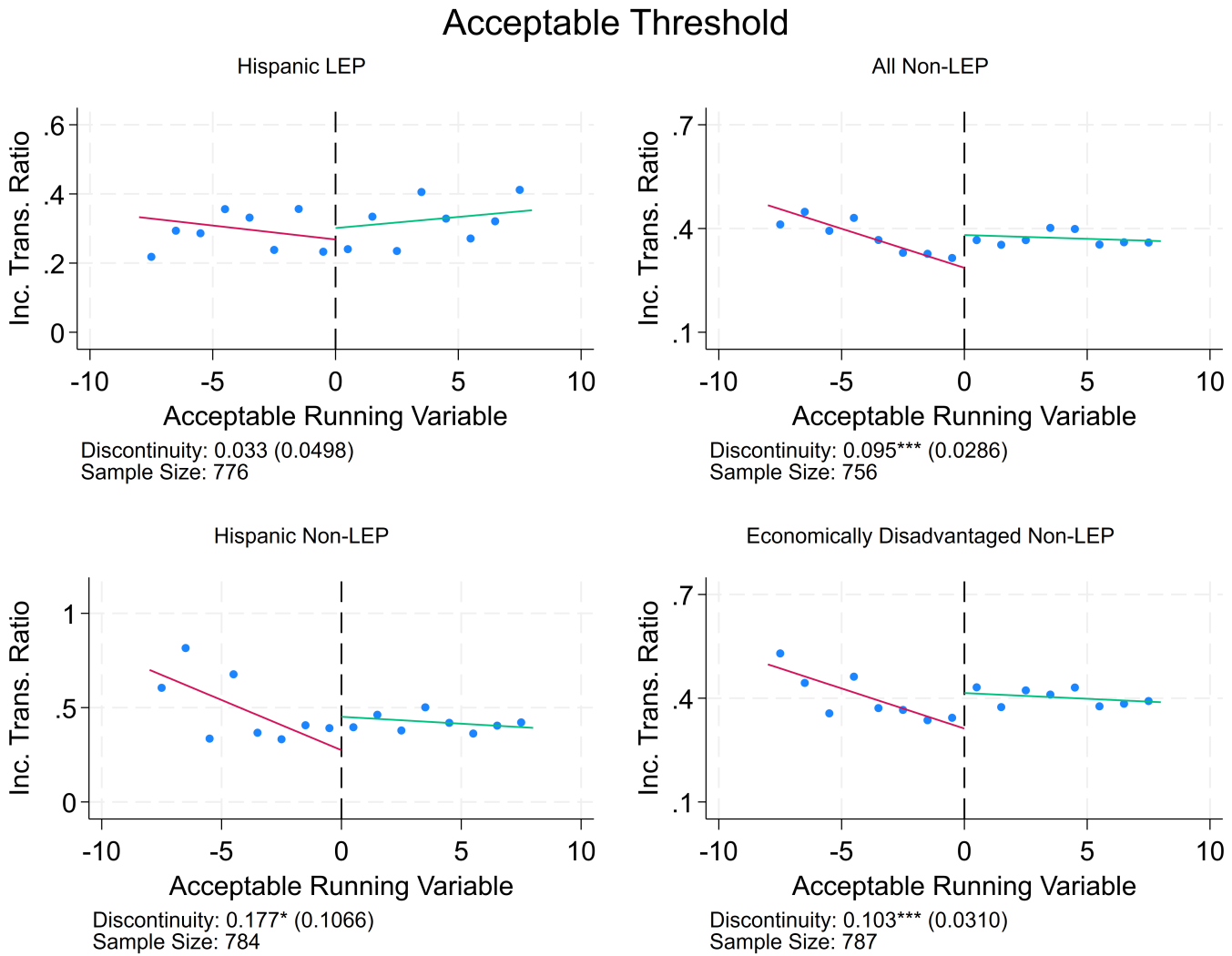
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Effect of Crossing a Rating on New Entrants and Leavers

	Hispanic LEP	All Non-LEP	Hispanic Non-LEP	Econ. Dis. Non-LEP
New Entrant Ratio				
Acceptable	0.002	0.016	0.075	0.011
	(0.036)	(0.033)	(0.055)	(0.032)
Recognized	0.005	0.005	-0.015	0.003
	(0.019)	(0.007)	(0.013)	(0.008)
Exemplary	0.007	0.007	0.012	0.003
	(0.025)	(0.006)	(0.014)	(0.008)
Leaver Ratio				
Acceptable	0.012	0.041	0.025	0.042
	(0.028)	(0.031)	(0.035)	(0.031)
Recognized	0.007	0.005	0.003	0.001
	(0.009)	(0.007)	(0.009)	(0.008)
Exemplary	0.008	0.001	-0.002	-0.002
	(0.012)	(0.005)	(0.007)	(0.006)

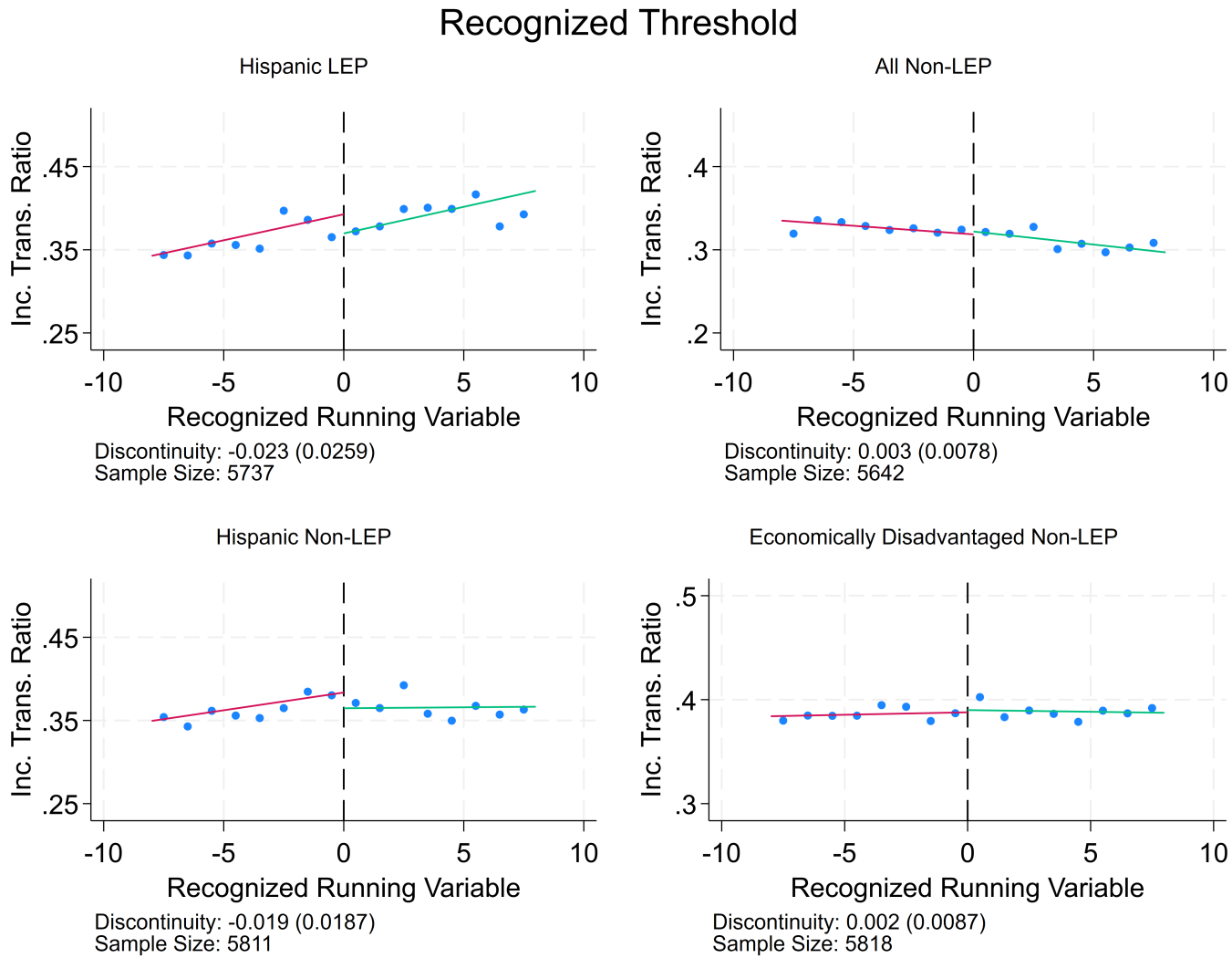
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Incoming Transfers by Student Group: Acceptable Margin



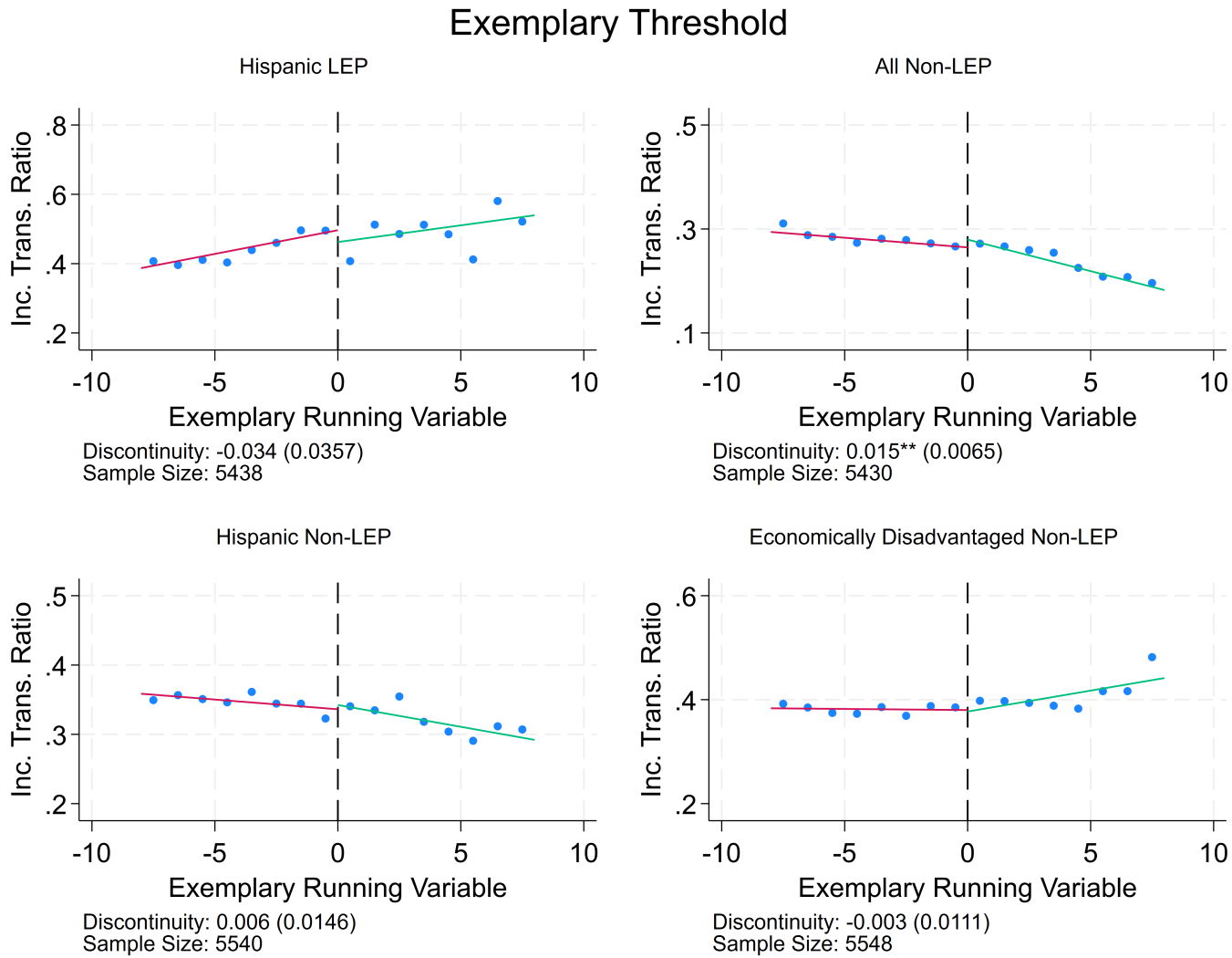
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Incoming Transfers by Student Group: Recognized Margin



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Incoming Transfers by Student Group: Exemplary Margin



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Spanish-Language TV Access

- Spanish-language TV as a test of *reach*
  - May increase exposure to locally relevant information in a language more accessible to Spanish-speaking households
  - If language limits access, responses should be stronger where Spanish-language media carries the rating
- Hand-collected coverage of Univision, TeleFutura, and Telemundo affiliates, Texas 2000–2008
  - Verified with FCC records; counties mapped to Nielsen DMAs
  - Indicator $= 1$ if the county's DMA has an affiliate: 127 of 254 counties
- RD remains valid within TV markets: coverage is unrelated to a school's position at the cutoff
  - But TV markets differ in other ways $\Rightarrow$ not a causal effect of TV access

Enrollment Change in Spanish-TV Markets

	Hispanic LEP	All Non-LEP	Hispanic Non-LEP	Econ. Dis. Non-LEP
Acceptable	0.080	0.040	0.130	0.030
	(0.063)	(0.039)	(0.084)	(0.039)
Recognized	-0.020	0.000	-0.040	0.000
	(0.041)	(0.010)	(0.026)	(0.011)
Exemplary	-0.040	0.020**	0.020	0.010
	(0.053)	(0.009)	(0.017)	(0.015)

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